

Board: 1
Dealer: **West**

Board: 3
Dealer: **West**

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 4 3

♥ J

♦ 10 9 7 3

♣ K J 6 5 2

♠ A J 10 6 2

♥ A 6 2

♦ Q J

♣ 10 8 7



♠ Q 9 8

♥ 10 7

♦ K 8 6 5 2

♣ Q 9 3

♠ K 5

♥ K Q 9 8 5 4 3

♦ A 4

♣ A 4

West	North	East	South
Pass	1♠	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥ ¹	Pass	5NT ²
Pass	6♥ ³		
All Pass			

1. 2 keycards, no trump Q
2. king ask
3. no kings lower than hearts

North opens 1♠. What do you respond with? You have a powerhouse, plenty strong enough to jump-shift. But playing 2/1 it's usually simpler when you make the 2/1 response, and save your jumping for later - if at all. So just bid 2♥, knowing North must keep the bidding open. North responds 3♥, setting the trump suit. Now you are definitely interested in slam. Since you have controls in all the side suits, you go right to keycard Blackwood, using the 1430 system. Partner responds 5♥.

Partner's 5♥ shows two keycards without the trump queen. But we have the other 3 keycards, and the trump queen. If partner has the two minor kings we might have a grand. We ask about these with our 5NT bid. Unfortunately, partner responds 6♥ (playing specific kings, this denies any kings lower than hearts). We will pass and play there. This is a good slam, cold if West makes any opening lead other than a ♣. With a ♣ lead, South will have to pull trumps and play to discard a loser on the ♠10.

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A
♥ A Q J 7 5 3
♦ 7 4 2
♣ K J 4

♠ 10 8 7 4

♥ 6 2

♦ J 10

♣ A 10 9 6 2



♠ Q J 2

♥ K 10

♦ K Q 8 6 5

♣ Q 8 7

♠ K 9 6 5 3

♥ 9 8 4

♦ A 9 3

♣ 5 3

West

1♥

2♥

All Pass

North

Pass

Pass

East

2♦

4♥

South

Pass

How do you start this action? [Bid 1H] You open 1♥ and partner responds 2♦. What do you rebid? Partner's 2 over 1 bid sets up a game force. You have a good-looking hand, but you need to find a trump suit before showing extra strength, so she bids just 2♥. You are in a game forcing auction, so partner won't pass you. Partner now jumps to 4♥. What do you do now?

Partner's jump to 4♥ is Fast Arrival - showing a minimum game forcing hand. Even though we have extra values, this won't be enough for slam opposite 13 or so points.